

SEO Keyword Research Guide

Three-Stage Framework for Finding Keywords That Drive Revenue, Not Just Traffic

Most keyword research goes wrong at stage one: people chase volume instead of commercial intent. This guide walks you through a three-stage process to find the keywords that actually convert — using free tools only.

**BEFORE
YOU START
—
KEY CONCEPTS**

1.
Co

Commercial Intent

The keyword signals the searcher wants to BUY, not just learn. "Best social media agency Dubai" is commercial. "What is social media" is not.

2. Search Volume

How many times the keyword is searched per month. High volume is useless without intent. A 100-search/month keyword with high

intent
beats a
10,000/
month
keyword
with
none.

3. Key word d Di ffic ulty (K D)

How
hard it is
to rank.
New
sites
should
target
KD
below
30. Establ
ished
sites can
target up
to 60.

STAG E 1 — SEED KEYW ORD DISC OVER Y

Goal:
Build a
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STAG E 2 — EXPA NSIO N & C LUST² ERIN G

Goal:
Take
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seed list
into a
tool,
expand
to 200–
300 key
words,
then
cluster
into
topic
groups.

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Total =
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score.
Build
pages
in order
of
highest
score
first.

**Comme
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Intent:

1 = purely informational, 5 = high buyer intent ("hire", "pricing", "best")

Search Volume:

1 = under 50/mo, 3 = 100–500/mo, 5 = 500+/mo

Keyword Difficulty:

5 = very easy (KD 0–15), 3 = moderate (KD 16–30), 1 = hard (KD 31+)

Business Relevance:

1 = tangential, 5 = core to your service offering and target client

Maximum score:

20 points.

Target keywords

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10.

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